

LLMMargin Pro Tier Playbook

Pro tier: \$19/mo or \$149/yr (save \$79, ~35% off). This doc is the single source of truth for the paywall implementation — every gate, every string, every trigger.

Section 1: Feature Gate Table

Gating rule: the number is always free. We gate everything that turns a number into a deliverable — exports, saves, multi-model compares, 12-month projections, full percentile breakdowns.

Feature	Free	Pro (\$19/mo)
Margin Simulator (/)		
Run calculation	Yes	Yes
Gross margin %	Yes	Yes
CPAU result	Yes	Yes
Breakeven MAU	Yes	Yes
Power user risk (summary)	Yes (p50 only)	Full (p50/p75/p95/p99)
12-month projection chart	Limited (3 months preview, blurred)	Full (12 months)
Model comparison (side-by-side)	Limited (2 models max)	Unlocked (up to 6)
Share URL	Yes	Yes
Export PDF	No	Unlocked
Save scenario	No	Unlocked (up to 50)
Cost-Per-User (/cost-per-user)		
Run calculation	Yes	Yes
CPAU result	Yes	Yes
Model comparison table (4 alts)	Limited (2 rows visible, 2 blurred)	Full (all 4 + custom)
Power user risk breakdown p50/p75/p95/p99	Limited (p50 only)	Full
Share URL	Yes	Yes
Export CSV	No	Unlocked
Save scenario	No	Unlocked
Budget Planner (/budget-planner)		
Run calculation	Yes	Yes

Feature	Free	Pro (\$19/mo)
Multi-tier table (free + paid)	Limited (2 tiers max)	Unlocked (unlimited tiers)
Add features	Limited (3 features max)	Unlocked (unlimited)
12-month projection	Limited (3 months preview)	Full (12 months)
Export budget PDF	No	Unlocked
Save scenario	No	Unlocked
Shareable URL	Yes	Yes

Section 2: The Paywall Trigger Playbook

Every gate routes to `/upgrade?trigger=<name>` which opens Stripe Checkout (v2) or a "coming soon" page (v1). All modals are dismissible with ESC or a secondary link.

Trigger 1 — Export PDF (Margin Simulator)

TRIGGER: `export_pdf_margin`
 UI: Modal (centered, backdrop blur), triggered on click of "Export PDF" button
 Headline: "Export this scenario as a PDF"
 Subtext: "Pro members can export investor-ready margin PDFs with your numbers, char
 CTA Button: "Upgrade to Pro – \$19/mo"
 Secondary link: "Maybe later"

Trigger 2 — Export CSV (Cost-Per-User)

TRIGGER: `export_csv_cpu`
 UI: Modal, triggered on click of "Export CSV" button
 Headline: "Export the full cost breakdown"
 Subtext: "Get every model, every percentile, and your custom inputs as a CSV you can
 CTA Button: "Upgrade to Pro – \$19/mo"
 Secondary link: "See what's included"

Trigger 3 — Export Budget PDF (Budget Planner)

TRIGGER: `export_pdf_budget`
 UI: Modal, triggered on click of "Export Budget PDF" button
 Headline: "Export your 12-month AI budget"
 Subtext: "Share a clean PDF with your cofounder, your board, or the VC who just aske
 CTA Button: "Upgrade to Pro – \$19/mo"
 Secondary link: "Maybe later"

Trigger 4 — Add 3rd Model to Compare

TRIGGER: add_model_3

UI: Inline chip (appears in-place where the "+ Add model" button is), with lock icon

Headline: "Compare more than 2 models"

Subtext: "Pro unlocks side-by-side comparison across every frontier model – GPT-4o,

CTA Button: "Unlock model comparison – \$19/mo"

Secondary link: "Keep comparing 2"

Trigger 5 — View 12-Month Projection

TRIGGER: projection_12mo

UI: Blur overlay on months 4-12 of the chart, with a centered card on top of the blur

Headline: "See the full 12 months"

Subtext: "You're looking at the first 3 months. Pro shows the full year so you can see

CTA Button: "Upgrade to Pro – \$19/mo"

Secondary link: "Not now"

Section 3: Pricing Page Copy (/pricing)

Page header

Headline: "Pricing for founders who'd rather not go broke on tokens."

Subheadline: "Start free. Upgrade when you need to hand a PDF to your board."

Free tier card

Tier name: Free

Price: \$0

Tagline: "Run the numbers. As many times as you want."

Features:

- Full margin, CPAU, and breakeven calculations
- Compare any 2 models side-by-side
- 3-month projection preview
- Shareable URLs for every scenario
- p50 power user risk estimate

CTA: "Start calculating"

Pro tier card

Tier name: Pro

Price: \$19/mo (toggle: \$149/yr – save \$79)

Badge: "Most popular"

Tagline: "Everything you need to turn a calculation into a deliverable."

Features (Free plus):

- Everything in Free

- ✨ Export to PDF (investor-ready)
- ✨ Export to CSV (drops into your model)
- ✨ Full 12-month projection
- ✨ Compare up to 6 models at once
- ✨ Full p50 / p75 / p95 / p99 power user risk
- ✨ Save up to 50 scenarios
- ✨ Unlimited tiers & features in Budget Planner

Annual callout: "Go annual and save \$79 – the equivalent of 4 months free."

CTA: "Upgrade to Pro"

Trust line: "Cancel anytime. No credit card required to explore the free tools."

FAQ

Q: What does "save scenarios" actually mean?

A: A named snapshot of your inputs (MAU, pricing, model, feature mix) that you can pull up later without re-typing. Saved to your account — not to your browser — so you can access them anywhere.

Q: Does this work with non-OpenAI models?

A: Yes. Anthropic (Claude 3.5, 3.7, Opus 4), Google (Gemini 1.5 / 2.0), Meta (Llama 3.1 / 3.3), Mistral, DeepSeek, and custom pricing for self-hosted or negotiated rates. We update pricing within a week of any provider change.

Q: What happens to my saved scenarios if I cancel?

A: You keep read-only and export access for 30 days after your subscription ends. After that, scenarios stay in your account but become read-only until you resubscribe. We never delete your data.

Q: Are the PDF exports actually investor-ready?

A: Yes — clean typography, your scenario name, the inputs you used, the model(s) compared, a margin chart, and a methodology note at the bottom so the person reading it knows what they're looking at. Founders have used these in seed and Series A decks.

Q: Will the free tier stay free forever?

A: Yes. The core calculations — margin, CPAU, breakeven — will always be free. The Free tier may change at the edges (e.g., we may add things to it), but we're not going to take the calculator away from you.

Section 4: Upgrade CTA Copy (In-Tool)

Lock icon tooltip — Export button (all 3 tools)

Location: Top-right of each tool, on the "Export" button (PDF or CSV).

Copy: ⓘ "Export is a Pro feature. Upgrade for \$19/mo."

Lock icon tooltip — 12-month projection expand

Location: Chart footer, on the "Expand to 12 months" control (Margin Simulator + Budget Planner).

Copy: ⓘ "See the full 12 months with Pro — \$19/mo."

Lock icon tooltip — "Add model" 3rd slot

Location: Model comparison row, on the "+ Add model" button once 2 models are already selected.

Copy: ⓘ "Compare 3+ models with Pro — \$19/mo."

"Pro" badge on blurred percentile rows

Location: Power user risk table (Cost-Per-User + Margin Simulator), on the p75 / p95 / p99 rows which appear blurred.

Copy: Small pill next to each blurred row: PRO — hover tooltip: "Your riskiest users are in p95/p99. Unlock them with Pro."

Sticky bottom banner (60-second trigger on free tools)

Location: Fixed bottom banner, slides up after 60 seconds of active use on any free tool. Dismissible with an X that suppresses it for 7 days.

Banner headline: "Like what you're seeing?"

Banner body: "Export this scenario as a PDF, save it, and get the full 12-month view

Primary CTA: "Upgrade to Pro"

Dismiss: "×"

Section 5: Post-Upgrade Email Sequence

Plain-text style, from founders@llmmargin.com. First name merge.

Email 1 — Immediately after upgrade

Subject: You're in. Here's what's unlocked.

Hey {{first_name}},

You're on Pro. Three things you can do right now:

1. Export any scenario as a PDF — top-right of every tool.
2. Save scenarios so you stop re-typing your MAU every time.
3. Compare up to 6 models side-by-side in the Cost-Per-User tool.

Your receipt is attached. Reply to this email if anything breaks — it goes straight

— The LLMMargin team

Email 2 — Day 3

Subject: The #1 thing Pro members do in their first week

Hey {{first_name}},

Most founders upgrade to Pro for one specific moment: the moment someone asks them

Next time you're building a pitch deck, a board update, or answering a diligence qu

It takes about 90 seconds and it makes you look like you've actually thought about un

Try it here: <https://llmmargin.com>

— The LLMMargin team

P.S. If you want a second tool to try: the Budget Planner's 12-month projection is t

Email 3 — Day 10

Subject: Quick one — annual plan + team use

Hey {{first_name}},

Two quick things, not a hard sell:

1. If you're planning to stick around, the annual plan is \$149 (vs. \$228 monthly) — \$
2. If your cofounder or CFO would get value from this, forward them your Pro PDF exp

That's it. Back to shipping.

— The LLMMargin team

Section 6: Stripe Implementation Notes

Product type

- **Stripe Product:** LLMMargin Pro (single product, two prices).
- **Billing type:** Recurring subscription. Not one-time.
- **Price IDs to create:**
 - `price_pro_monthly` — \$19.00 USD / month
 - `price_pro_annual` — \$149.00 USD / year
- Use **Stripe Checkout** (hosted) for v1 — do not build a custom card form. Redirect URLs:
`success_url=/upgrade/success?session_id={CHECKOUT_SESSION_ID}`, `cancel_url=/pricing`.

Client-side gating after payment (v1, no database)

On `/upgrade/success`, the Next.js route handler:

1. Receives `session_id`.
2. Calls Stripe server-side (`stripe.checkout.sessions.retrieve`) to confirm `payment_status === 'paid'` and extract customer + subscription IDs.
3. Issues a signed JWT (HS256, secret in env var) with payload: `{ sub: customer_id, sub_id: subscription_id, plan: 'pro', exp: period_end_unix }`.
4. Returns the JWT to the client; the client stores it in `localStorage` under key `llmmargin_pro`.

All gated UI checks: `const isPro = verifyJWT(localStorage.getItem('llmmargin_pro'))`. Verification is done client-side against the **public half** of an asymmetric key (switch JWT to RS256 for this) so the secret never ships to the browser.

Tradeoff: This is spoofable. A user can paste any valid JWT they obtain (e.g., from their own paid account on another machine) into `localStorage` and unlock features. Acceptable for v1 because:

- All calculations are client-side anyway — there is no server-held value to steal.
- Exports are generated client-side from data the user already typed.
- The conversion cost of this abuse is ~\$19, and the population willing to spoof JWTs to avoid \$19 is tiny.

v2 fix: Move export generation and "save scenario" to a server endpoint that verifies the JWT's `sub_id` against Stripe's current subscription status. No local bypass possible.

Checking Pro status without a database

Two supported paths:

1. JWT in `localStorage` (primary) — as above. Client reads, verifies signature, checks `exp`.
2. Stripe Customer Portal link (fallback + re-auth) — if JWT is missing or expired, show a "Restore Pro" button that links to `https://billing.stripe.com/p/login/{portal_config_id}` prefilled with the user's email. On return, re-issue a JWT via a server route that looks up the customer by email and confirms an active subscription.

Webhook events to handle

Endpoint: `POST /api/stripe/webhook` with signature verification.

Event	Action
<code>checkout.session.completed</code>	Mint JWT, email receipt (Email 1).
<code>customer.subscription.updated</code>	If status changed to <code>past_due</code> or <code>canceled</code> , flag email for send.

Event	Action
<code>customer.subscription.deleted</code>	Send 30-day read-only notice; on expiry, revoke JWT (next client load invalidates).
<code>invoice.payment_failed</code>	Send recovery email with Customer Portal link.
<code>invoice.payment_succeeded</code> (renewals)	Re-issue JWT with new exp — delivered via email link or on next app load.

Security tradeoff — the one clear note

v1 ships with localStorage-based Pro status. This is spoofable. We accept that because exports are client-generated and the revenue at risk is trivial. v2 moves exports server-side and verifies Stripe subscription status on every gated request — at that point, spoofing the JWT gets you nothing.

End of playbook. If you're the developer implementing this: start with the feature gate table, then the 5 triggers, then Stripe. Pricing page and emails can ship day 2.